

Standard Chartered

3Q25: Good quarter

Reiterate Rating: UNDERPERFORM | PO: 150.50 HKD | Price: 157.80 HKD

Overall: Good 3Q across all lines

Overall, Standard Chartered printed a good set of 3Q numbers. Underlying PBT was 14% (or \$243m) ahead of consensus, driven by higher income and lower impairments. Within the income line, the beat was from both NII and non-NII, and within non-NII, Wealth and Banking beat expectations while Global Markets missed. While results were good, valuation at c.1.1x P/TBV 26e for c.13% ROTE (lowered to c.11-12% including restructuring) does not look particularly cheap versus the sector and we see better opportunities elsewhere. However, we have increased our price objective from HKD139.1 to HKD150.5, reflecting higher profitability as well as a stronger USDGBP exchange rate.

3Q25 summary - c.10% pre provision beat

Underlying PBT was 14% (or \$243m) ahead of consensus, reflecting a 3% (or \$166m) beat in income, a 1% (or \$27m) beat in cost, and credit impairment which was 23% (or \$57m) better. Beat was c.10% at the pre-provision level. Within income, NII was 2% (or \$65m) ahead and non-NII was 4% (or \$101m) ahead. The beat in non-NII was driven by higher Banking and Wealth, partially offset by lower Global Markets given lower episodic income as previously communicated. CET1 of 14.2% was slightly ahead of consensus 14.1%, reflecting higher profits.

Guidance - upgraded FY25 guidance on income and ROTE

Management upgraded two key pieces of guidance, including (i) income growth to be towards upper end of 5-7% range (previously guided around bottom of range) at constant currency (ccy), ex notable items. Implied total income of c.\$20.7bn (consensus c.\$20.6bn); and expect to deliver an underlying RoTE of c.13% in 2025 (consensus c.13.1%). Management also confirmed that updated 2026 ROTE will be provided at FY25 results, and medium-term financial expectations will be provided in May 2026.

Estimates (Dec) (US\$)	2023A	2024A	2025E	2026E	2027E
Net Income (Adjusted - mn)	3,581	4,276	5,310	5,076	5,454
EPS	1.29	1.68	2.29	2.35	2.70
EPS Change (YoY)	31.7%	30.4%	36.1%	2.7%	14.9%
Consensus EPS (Visible Alpha)			1.94	2.05	2.68
Dividend / Share	0.27	0.37	0.53	0.52	0.67
Adjusted NAV PS	13.93	15.41	17.57	18.75	20.47
Valuation (Dec)					
P/E	15.75x	12.07x	8.87x	8.64x	7.52x
Price / NAV	1.46x	1.32x	1.16x	1.08x	0.99x
Net Yield	1.33%	1.82%	2.61%	2.56%	3.32%

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Refer to important disclosures on page 7 to 9. Analyst Certification on page 4. Price Objective Basis/Risk on page 4.

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03 November 2025

Equity

Key Changes

(US\$)	Previous	Current
Price Obj.	HK\$139.10	HK\$150.50
2025E EPS	2.15	2.29
2026E EPS	2.21	2.35
2027E EPS	2.51	2.70

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Stock Data

Price	157.80 HKD
Price Objective	150.50 HKD
Date Established	3-Nov-2025
Investment Opinion	B-3-7
52-Week Range	86.25 HKD-160.60 HKD
Mkt Val / Shares Out (mn)	46,372 USD / 2,284.0
Market Value (mn)	360,416 HKD
Average Daily Value (mn)	15.81 USD
Free Float	100.0%
BofA Ticker / Exchange	XCHBF / HKG
Bloomberg / Reuters	2888 HK / 2888.HK
ROE (2025E)	10.4%

NII: Net interest income

ROTE: Return on tangible equity

RWA: Risk weighted assets

AUM: Asset under management

NNM: Net new money

CRE: Commercial real estate

LTV: Loan to value

iQprofileSM Standard Chartered

Key Income Statement Data (Dec)

(US\$ Millions)

	2023A	2024A	2025E	2026E	2027E
Net Interest Income	10,257	11,096	10,867	10,891	10,999
Net Fee Income	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
Securities Gains / (Losses)	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
Other Income	7,121	8,600	10,037	10,371	11,081
Total Non-Interest Income	7,121	8,600	10,037	10,371	11,081
Total Operating Income	17,378	19,696	20,904	21,262	22,080
Operating Expenses	(11,136)	(11,790)	(12,217)	(12,430)	(12,758)
Pre-Provision Profit	6,242	7,906	8,687	8,832	9,322
Provisions Expense	(658.00)	(1,146)	(844.95)	(1,068)	(1,097)
Operating Profit	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
Non-Operating Income	(491.00)	(747.00)	(680.00)	(960.00)	(200.00)
Pre-Tax Income	5,093	6,013	7,162	6,804	8,025
Net Income to Comm S/Hold.	3,017	3,593	4,725	4,325	5,238
Adjusted Net Income (Operating)	3,581	4,276	5,310	5,076	5,454

Key Balance Sheet Data

Total Assets	822,844	849,688	920,196	939,965	958,998
Average Interest Earning Assets	572,520	539,338	551,628	596,766	616,167
Weighted Risk Assets	244,151	247,065	262,684	274,747	283,661
Total Gross Customer Loans	292,145	285,936	290,323	300,355	309,381
Total Customer Deposits	469,418	464,489	527,350	551,486	574,114
Tier 1 Capital	39,806	41,672	43,335	43,571	44,425
Tangible Equity	38,231	38,597	40,754	40,620	41,518
Common Shareholders' Equity	44,445	44,388	46,899	47,035	48,129

Key Metrics

Net Interest Margin	1.79%	2.06%	1.97%	1.83%	1.79%
Tier 1 Ratio	16.3%	16.9%	16.5%	15.9%	15.7%
Effective Tax Rate	32.0%	32.8%	26.0%	28.5%	28.0%
Loan / Assets Ratio	34.9%	33.1%	31.0%	31.4%	31.7%
Loan / Deposit Ratio	61.1%	60.5%	54.1%	53.6%	53.0%
Oper Leverage (Inc Growth - Cost Growth)	3.3%	7.5%	2.5%	0%	1.2%
Gearing (Assets / Equity)	18.5x	19.1x	19.6x	20.0x	19.9x
Tangible Common Equity / Assets	4.6%	4.5%	4.4%	4.3%	4.3%
Tangible Common Equity / WRAs	15.7%	15.6%	15.5%	14.8%	14.6%
Revenue Growth	10.3%	13.3%	6.1%	1.7%	3.8%
Operating Expense Growth	7.0%	5.9%	3.6%	1.7%	2.6%
Provisions Expense Growth	-24.8%	74.2%	-26.3%	26.4%	2.7%
Operating Revenue / Average Assets	0.7%	0.8%	0.9%	0.8%	0.9%
Operating Expenses / Average Assets	-1.4%	-1.4%	-1.4%	-1.3%	-1.3%
Pre-Provision ROA	0.8%	0.9%	1.0%	0.9%	1.0%
ROA	0.4%	0.4%	0.5%	0.5%	0.6%
Pre-Provision ROE	14.3%	17.8%	19.0%	18.8%	19.6%
ROE	6.9%	8.1%	10.4%	9.2%	11.0%
RoTE	9.9%	11.6%	13.9%	13.0%	13.8%
RoWRAs	7.1%	8.0%	8.2%	7.9%	7.9%
Dividend Payout Ratio	20.9%	22.0%	23.1%	22.2%	25.0%
Efficiency Ratio	64.1%	59.9%	58.4%	58.5%	57.8%
Headline Cost/Income Ratio	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
Total Non-Interest Inc / Operating Inc	59%	56%	52%	51%	50%
Market-Related Revenue / Total Revenues	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
Provisioning Burden as % of PPP	10.5%	14.5%	9.7%	12.1%	11.8%
NPLs plus Foreclosed Real Estate / Loans	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
Loan Loss Reserves / NPLs	71.5%	79.1%	77.9%	75.3%	73.1%
Loan Loss Reserves / Total Loans	1.8%	1.7%	1.7%	1.7%	1.6%
Provisions Expense / Average Loans	0.2%	0.4%	0.3%	0.4%	0.4%

Other Metrics

Income / Employee	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
(Operating Expenses) / Employee	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
Pre-Provision Profit / Employee	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
Net Profit / Employee	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA

Company Sector

Banks-Multinational/Universal

Company Description

Standard Chartered is headquartered in London, but its major operations are in Asia and Africa, with a diverse footprint within these continents. Standard Chartered has three main divisions: 1) Corporate, Commercial and Institutional Banking, 2) Consumer, Private and Business Banking, and 3) Ventures. The shares are listed in both London and Hong Kong in a dual primary listing.

Investment Rationale

We rate Standard Chartered Underperform. It may not appear expensive, despite strong share price performance in 2024. However, we see downside risks from here given NII compression in a falling US rate environment. In addition, emerging markets are likely to face more macro headwinds given a more protectionist US trade policy, which limits both loan growth and fee income growth upside. While we remain positive on Wealth, consensus has likely priced in most of the upside potential.

Stock Data

Price to Book Value

1.0x



Estimate changes

PBT: We have increased our underlying PBT by c.5-6%, reflecting higher non-interest income, driven by the 3Q performance, as well as higher Wealth forecasts. Reported EPS are increased by more as we reduce the tax rate by c.1-1.5%.

Income: We have increased non-interest forecasts by 3-5%, largely reflecting higher Wealth forecasts. The key change is higher margins – in the past two quarters we had seen wealth margins close to c.1% (previous 1H margins c.1.3-1.4%). In 3Q, this was increased to c.1.20%, in part reflecting higher balances in wealth products.

Impairment: We have reduced impairment by c.8% in 2025, reflecting lower 3Q print.

Cost exceptionals: We have moved some of the fit for growth (FFG) cost restructuring into 2026. As at 3Q25, only \$454m of the \$1.5bn planned had been spent, and we therefore expect a run rate of c.\$200m per quarter. We also expect c.\$200-300m of 'other' cost exceptionals – as at 3Q25 this is c.\$200m so far in 2025.

Tax: We have reduced our tax rate forecast from c.29-30% to c.28-29%, reflecting the lower print in 2025. While the 2025 print benefitted from reduced tax losses in the UK, we expect the go-forward rate to benefit from actions taken so far.

RWA: We have increased RWA forecasts by c.2%, reflecting a timing difference in operational risk inflation, which is now expected to be in 4Q instead of 1Q.

Exhibit 1: Estimate changes FY25-FY27

We upgraded underlying PBT by 5-6%

	2025E			2026E			2027E		
	New	Old	Change	New	Old	Change	New	Old	Change
Underlying P&L (\$m)									
Net interest income	10,867	10,862	0%	10,891	10,891	0%	10,999	11,002	0%
Non Interest income	10,037	9,739	3%	10,371	9,930	4%	11,081	10,563	5%
Total income	20,904	20,601	1%	21,262	20,821	2%	22,080	21,565	2%
Operating costs	(12,217)	(12,194)	0%	(12,430)	(12,409)	0%	(12,758)	(12,733)	0%
Pre-provision profits	8,687	8,406	3%	8,832	8,412	5%	9,322	8,832	6%
Credit impairment	(770)	(839)	-8%	(983)	(978)	1%	(1,012)	(1,007)	1%
Other impairment	(75)	(85)	-12%	(85)	(95)	-11%	(85)	(95)	-11%
Associates and JV	90	90	0%	90	100	-10%	100	100	0%
Underlying PBT	7,932	7,572	5%	7,854	7,439	6%	8,325	7,830	6%
Income exceptionals	0	0		0	0		0	0	
Cost exceptionals	(770)	(850)		(1,050)	(850)		(300)	(400)	
Impairment exceptionals	-	-		-	-		-	-	
Stat profit before tax	7,162	6,722	7%	6,804	6,589	3%	8,025	7,430	8%
Tax	(1,862)	(1,882)		(1,939)	(1,911)		(2,247)	(2,118)	
Minority and prefs	(575)	(500)		(540)	(500)		(540)	(500)	
Statutory AP	4,725	4,340	9%	4,325	4,178	4%	5,238	4,813	9%
Profitability Metrics									
EPS (reported)	204	187	9%	200	193	4%	259	237	9%
EPS (underlying)	229	215	6%	235	221	6%	270	251	7%
Stat ROTE	12.4%	11.4%	0.9%	11.0%	10.7%	0.3%	13.2%	12.3%	1.0%
Underlying ROTE	13.9%	13.1%	0.8%	13.0%	12.3%	0.6%	13.8%	13.0%	0.8%
Key balance sheet items (\$m)									
Loans and advances to customers	285,419	285,425	0%	295,451	295,465	0%	304,477	304,523	0%
Tangible Equity	39,260	38,855	1%	39,126	38,886	1%	40,024	39,565	1%
TBVPs	17.57	17.41	1%	18.75	18.60	1%	20.47	20.14	2%
Capital and Distributions									
CET1 ratio	14.0%	14.1%	-0.1%	13.5%	13.6%	-0.1%	13.4%	13.4%	0.0%
Risk Weighted Assets	262,684	258,446	2%	274,747	270,329	2%	283,661	279,413	2%
DPS (c)	52.9	48.6	9%	52.1	50.3	4%	67.4	61.7	9%
Buyback announced	2,800	2,800	0%	3,000	2,850	5%	3,000	2,850	5%

Source: BofA Global Research estimates

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH



Price objective basis & risk

Standard Chartered (XCHBF)

Our valuation methodology is a Gordon Growth Model based on our 2027E forecasts, to which we add the present value of expected dividends. With a 12.5% cost of equity assumption, this suggests a price to book multiple of 1.0x, reducing to 0.8x when discounted to a year from now at our cost of equity. We apply this to 2026E tangible book value and add the dividends we forecast through to 2027E (also discounted), and adjust for excess capital to the bottom end of management guidance. Using this valuation approach, we arrive at a price objective of HKD150.5.

Upside risks to our PO are 1) US rates stay higher for longer, terminal rate higher than expected, 2) further stimulus from the Chinese government, 3) Emerging Asia/ Hong Kong loan growth recovers faster than expected.

Downside risks to our PO are 1) loan growth remains subdued for longer, 2) Wealth Management flows slow as competition intensifies, 3) global trade flows reduce more than expected with higher tariffs.

Analyst Certification

I, Emma Xu, hereby certify that the views expressed in this research report accurately reflect my personal views about the subject securities and issuers. I also certify that no part of my compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or view expressed in this research report.

Greater China - Financials Coverage Cluster

Investment rating	Company	BofA Ticker	Bloomberg symbol	Analyst
BUY				
	AIA Group Limited	AAIGF	1299 HK	Michael Li
	Bank of Chengdu	XBCQF	601838 CH	Wenqing Han, CFA
	Bank Of Communications Co-A	XNCTF	601328 CH	Winnie Wu
	Bank of Jiangsu	XBJCF	600919 CH	Wenqing Han, CFA
	Bank of Ningbo	XBINF	002142 CH	Wenqing Han, CFA
	BOC Hong Kong Holdings Ltd	BNKHF	2388 HK	Winnie Wu
	China CITIC Bk	CHBJF	998 HK	Emma Xu
	China Construction Bank -A	XCTBF	601939 CH	Winnie Wu
	China Galaxy Securities Co Ltd	CGXYF	6881 HK	Susie Liu, CFA
	China Galaxy Securities Co Ltd	XCXYF	601881 CH	Susie Liu, CFA
	China International Capital Corporation	CNCF	3908 HK	Susie Liu, CFA
	China Life Insurance	CLJF	2628 HK	Michael Li
	China Pacific Insurance Group	CHPXF	2601 HK	Michael Li
	China Securities Corp	CSCFF	6066 HK	Susie Liu, CFA
	Chongqing Rural Commercial Bank	COGQF	3618 HK	Wenqing Han, CFA
	Chongqing Rural Commercial Bank - A	XCRQF	601077 CH	Wenqing Han, CFA
	CITIC Securities	CIHF	6030 HK	Susie Liu, CFA
	CITIC Securities -A	CIISF	600030 CH	Susie Liu, CFA
	CTBC FHC	CTFHF	2891 TT	Susie Liu, CFA
	E.Sun FHC	ESUFF	2884 TT	Michael Li
	Futu Holdings	FUTU	FUTU US	Emma Xu
	GF Securities	GFSEF	1776 HK	Susie Liu, CFA
	GF Securities	XMPQF	000776 CH	Susie Liu, CFA
	Guolian Minsheng Securities	XLTYF	601456 CH	Susie Liu, CFA
	HKEX	HKXCF	388 HK	Michael Li
	Huatai Securities	XHTLF	601688 CH	Susie Liu, CFA
	Ind & Comm BK	IDCBF	1398 HK	Winnie Wu
	PICC Group	PINXF	1339 HK	Michael Li
	PICC Property & Casualty	PPCCF	2328 HK	Michael Li
	Ping An Insurance	PIAIF	2318 HK	Michael Li
	Qifu Technology	QFIN	QFIN US	Emma Xu
	Qifu Technology	XDXRF	3660 HK	Emma Xu



Greater China - Financials Coverage Cluster

Investment rating	Company	BofA Ticker	Bloomberg symbol	Analyst
	Sinolink Securities	XERQF	600109 CH	Susie Liu, CFA
	UP Fintech Holding	TIGR	TIGR US	Emma Xu
	Zheshang Securities	XDSEF	601878 CH	Susie Liu, CFA
	ZhongAn Online P&C Insurance	ZZHGF	6060 HK	Michael Li

NEUTRAL

	Agricultural Bank of China	ACGBF	1288 HK	Winnie Wu
	Bank Of China	BACHF	3988 HK	Winnie Wu
	Bank Of China -A	BACZF	601988 CH	Winnie Wu
	Bank of Comm	BKFCF	3328 HK	Winnie Wu
	Bank of Hangzhou	XBHCF	600926 CH	Wenqing Han, CFA
	Bank of Nanjing	XBNMF	601009 CH	Wenqing Han, CFA
	Bank of Suzhou	XCZIF	002966 CH	Wenqing Han, CFA
	Cathay FHC	XCIF	2882 TT	Michael Li
	Chailease	XCAHZ	5871 TT	Susie Liu, CFA
	China Construction Bank	CICF	939 HK	Winnie Wu
	China Intl Capital Corp - A	XCCIF	601995 CH	Susie Liu, CFA
	Fubon FHC	FUISF	2881 TT	Michael Li
	Guotai Haitong Securities	GUOSF	2611 HK	Susie Liu, CFA
	Guotai Haitong Securities-A	XOQOF	601211 CH	Susie Liu, CFA
	HSBC	XHSBF	5 HK	Emma Xu
	Huatai Securities	HUATF	6886 HK	Susie Liu, CFA
	Ind & Comm BK -A	XIKNF	601398 CH	Winnie Wu
	Jiangsu Changshu Rural Commercial Bank	XBJTF	601128 CH	Wenqing Han, CFA
	Ping An Insurance	XPSPF	601318 CH	Michael Li
	Postal Savings Bank of China - A	XPSSF	601658 CH	Winnie Wu

UNDERPERFORM

	Agricultural Bank Of China-A	XACNF	601288 CH	Winnie Wu
	Bank of E Asia	BKEAF	23 HK	Emma Xu
	Bank of E Asia-A	BKEAY	BKEAY US	Emma Xu
	BOC International (China)	XLTF	601696 CH	Susie Liu, CFA
	China CITIC Bk -A	CHCKF	601998 CH	Emma Xu
	China Everbright Bank	CEBCF	6818 HK	Emma Xu
	China Everbright Bank	XCBLF	601818 CH	Emma Xu
	China Industrial Bank Co. Ltd.	INBLF	601166 CH	Emma Xu
	China Life Insurance	XCNNF	601628 CH	Michael Li
	China MERCH BK -A	CIHKF	600036 CH	Winnie Wu
	China Merchants Bank	CIHMF	3968 HK	Winnie Wu
	China Merchants Securities	XMRKF	600999 CH	Susie Liu, CFA
	China Merchants Securities	XQJRF	6099 HK	Susie Liu, CFA
	China Minsheng Banking Corp Ltd	CGMBF	1988 HK	Emma Xu
	China Minsheng Banking Corp Ltd -A	CMAKF	600016 CH	Emma Xu
	China Pacific Insurance Group	XCJNF	601601 CH	Michael Li
	China Securities Corp	XCSIF	601066 CH	Susie Liu, CFA
	New China Life	NWWCF	1336 HK	Michael Li
	New China Life	XNWCF	601336 CH	Michael Li
	Orient Securities	XOBNF	600958 CH	Susie Liu, CFA
	Orient Securities	XONQF	3958 HK	Susie Liu, CFA
	PICC Group	XPIDF	601319 CH	Michael Li
	Ping An Bank	XPABY	000001 CH	Emma Xu
	Postal Savings Bank of China	PSBKF	1658 HK	Winnie Wu
	Shanghai Pudong Dev Bank	SHVPF	600000 CH	Emma Xu
	Shanghai Rural Commercial Bank	XQZAF	601825 CH	Wenqing Han, CFA
	Standard Chartered	XCHBF	2888 HK	Emma Xu

RSTR

	Hang Seng Bk	HSNGF	11 HK	Emma Xu
	Hang Seng Bk - A	HSNGY	HSNGY US	Emma Xu

RVW

	Lufax Holding	LU	LU US	Emma Xu
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iQmethodSM Measures Definitions

Business Performance

Return On Capital Employed

Return On Equity

Operating Margin

Earnings Growth

Free Cash Flow

Quality of Earnings

Cash Realization Ratio

Asset Replacement Ratio

Tax Rate

Net Debt-To-Equity Ratio

Interest Cover

Valuation Toolkit

Price / Earnings Ratio

Price / Book Value

Dividend Yield

Free Cash Flow Yield

Enterprise Value / Sales

EV / EBITDA

Numerator

NOPAT = (EBIT + Interest Income) × (1 – Tax Rate) + Goodwill Amortization

Net Income

Operating Profit

Expected 5 Year CAGR From Latest Actual

Cash Flow From Operations – Total Capex

Numerator

Cash Flow From Operations

Capex

Tax Charge

Net Debt = Total Debt – Cash & Equivalents

EBIT

Numerator

Current Share Price

Current Share Price

Annualised Declared Cash Dividend

Cash Flow From Operations – Total Capex

EV = Current Share Price × Current Shares + Minority Equity + Net Debt +

Other LT Liabilities

Enterprise Value

Denominator

Total Assets – Current Liabilities + ST Debt + Accumulated Goodwill

Amortization

Shareholders' Equity

Sales

N/A

N/A

Denominator

Net Income

Depreciation

Pre-Tax Income

Total Equity

Interest Expense

Denominator

Diluted Earnings Per Share (Basis As Specified)

Shareholders' Equity / Current Basic Shares

Current Share Price

Market Cap = Current Share Price × Current Basic Shares

Sales

Basic EBIT + Depreciation + Amortization

iQmethodSM is the set of BofA Global Research standard measures that serve to maintain global consistency under three broad headings: Business Performance, Quality of Earnings, and validations. The key features of iQmethod are: A consistently structured, detailed, and transparent methodology. Guidelines to maximize the effectiveness of the comparative valuation process, and to identify some common pitfalls.

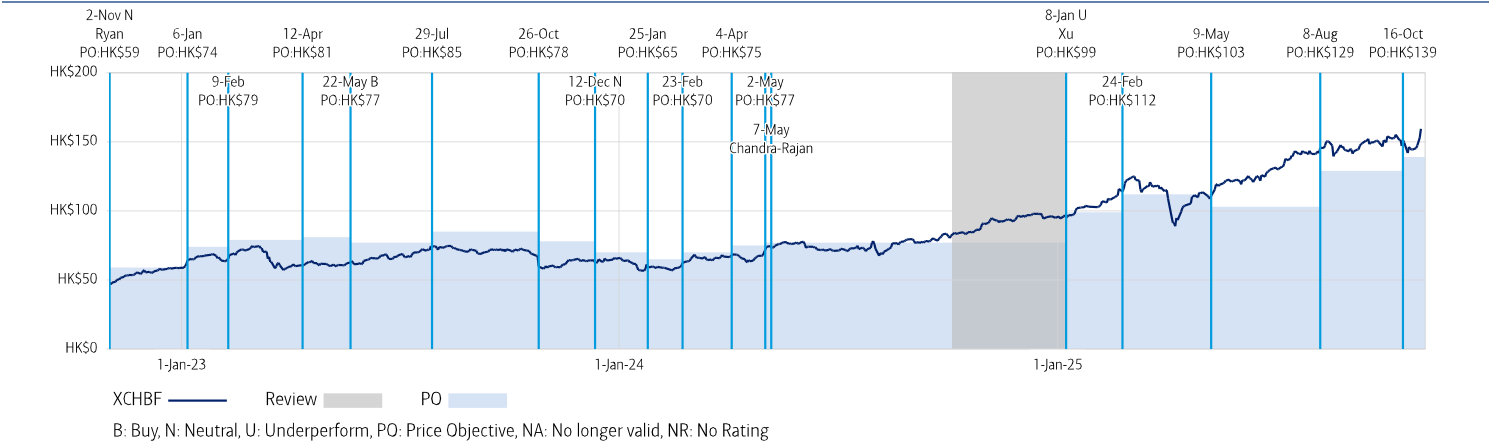
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Disclosures

Important Disclosures

Standard Chartered (XCHBF) Price Chart



Equity Investment Rating Distribution: Banks Group (as of 30 Sep 2025)

Coverage Universe	Count	Percent	Inv. Banking Relationships ^{R1}	Count	Percent
Buy	112	53.33%	Buy	91	81.25%
Hold	50	23.81%	Hold	39	78.00%
Sell	48	22.86%	Sell	39	81.25%

Equity Investment Rating Distribution: Global Group (as of 30 Sep 2025)

Coverage Universe	Count	Percent	Inv. Banking Relationships ^{R1}	Count	Percent
Buy	1816	53.11%	Buy	1062	58.48%
Hold	825	24.13%	Hold	480	58.18%
Sell	778	22.76%	Sell	385	49.49%

^{R1} Issuers that were investment banking clients of BofA Securities or one of its affiliates within the past 12 months. For purposes of this Investment Rating Distribution, the coverage universe includes only stocks. A stock rated Neutral is included as a Hold, and a stock rated Underperform is included as a Sell.

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Investment rating	Total return expectation (within 12-month period of date of initial rating)	Ratings dispersion guidelines for coverage cluster ^{R2}
Buy	≥ 10%	≤ 70%
Neutral	≥ 0%	≤ 30%
Underperform	N/A	≥ 20%

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